

Atlas Architecture Decision Compendium

Contoso | Atlas Customer Onboarding | Synthetic enterprise project artifact

Executive Context

Atlas addresses the gap between a signed enterprise deal and a stable production handoff. The existing process relies on regional checklists, manual status chasing, and inconsistent definitions of when onboarding is truly complete. The target model establishes a governed enterprise stage taxonomy while allowing approved regional substeps.

Phase 1 deliberately focuses on enterprise onboarding. SMB is deferred because its volume, automation expectations, and exception patterns are materially different. The project is expected to prove the operating model before broadening scope.

Business Requirements

CRM remains authoritative for customer identity and onboarding status. Atlas orchestrates work but does not create a competing customer master. Users need clear task ownership, blocked-state visibility, auditable exceptions, and client-facing status that does not expose internal-only detail.

High-risk legal, security, and contractual exceptions require human approval. The system must record who approved or rejected an exception, the supporting rationale, and the state transition that followed.

Architecture and Dependencies

Atlas resolves customer identity through CRM, authenticates pilot users through the Harbor interim SSO bridge, and maintains onboarding orchestration state in Atlas-owned services. Harbor modernization continues independently; Atlas does not wait for the complete Harbor migration.

Nova and Atlas share a dependency on CRM identity quality. The projects do not share workflow state, but duplicate or inconsistent customer records can affect both. Cross-project concerns are escalated through enterprise architecture rather than solved with local copies.

Delivery and Risk

Key risks include duplicate customer records, regional stage mismatch, Harbor SSO timing, legal exception review, and uneven client readiness. Each risk has an accountable owner and must be reflected in acceptance coverage where it can affect production behavior.

A dependency delay does not automatically move the Atlas milestone. The project manager first evaluates resequencing, degraded-mode options, and scope protection before requesting a steering decision.

Governance and Traceability

Material scope and architecture decisions are retained with rationale, alternatives, owners, and supersession history. Older assumptions are preserved because they explain later design choices. Current truth should be determined from accepted decisions and later revisions, not simply from the newest timestamp.

The project memory corpus intentionally contains overlapping meeting, email, SharePoint, OneDrive, and Confluence evidence so provenance and conflict resolution can be evaluated.

Rejected Approaches

A separate Atlas customer master was rejected because it creates reconciliation ambiguity. Waiting for full Harbor completion was rejected because it unnecessarily couples program timelines. Fully independent regional workflows were rejected because they preserve the fragmentation Atlas is intended to remove.

Anti-patterns

Do not encode business stages as undocumented flags, use free text as authoritative state, bypass approvals to unblock a milestone, or duplicate identities when CRM resolution fails. Preserve superseded decisions with their rationale.